ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 8: **The Sermon at Benares (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** therapeutic	It heals through insight.
2	**(b)** told her directly	Direct statements would fail.
3	**(b)** had found	Third conditional.
4	**(a)** retelling for modern readers	Retelling.
5	**(c)** the search for a death-free house shows death everywhere	She seeks life and finds universal death.
6	**(b)** Grief is an arrow lodged in the heart.	Direct identification without 'like' or 'as'.
7	**(b)** stress that there was no exception	Emphatic negative.
8	**(b)** teach rather than to fail her	Pedagogic.
9	**(d)** gentle and authoritative	Calm authority.
10	**(c)** stays by the grieving	Constant compassion.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	She seeks life for her son (1) but her search proves death is everywhere (1).	1+1
12	They make grief and death concrete (1) and show grief as a harmful dart that can be pulled out (1).	1+1
13	It is an ancient holy city (1) and a centre of spiritual teaching (1).	1+1
14	Mustard seed is concrete and ordinary (1) and failing to find it makes the abstract idea of universal death real (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It is indirect and respects her feelings (1). It lets her reach the truth through experience (1). It may fail if the sufferer refuses to try (1).	1+1+1
16	Both lose something precious (1). Lencho turns to God for restoration (1). Kisa Gotami turns to the Buddha and learns acceptance (1).	1+1+1
17	Grieving deeply, Kisa Gotami wandered from house to house (1). The participle phrase replaces a clause (1). Subjects must match (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It opens with intense grief (1). The search builds suspense (1). The sermon closes with calm reflection (1).	1+1+1
18	The teacher guides without forcing (1). The learner discovers truth herself (1). The relationship is based on trust (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It is a metaphor (1). Grief is compared to an arrow without 'like' (1). It suggests that sorrow is a wound (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Denial in Kisa Gotami (1). The search as a method (1). Realisation of universality (1). Sermon's lines on grief (1). Peace and compassion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Intro (1). Story (1). Meaning (1). Personal reflection (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Narrative: story and dialogue (1). Symbol: mustard seed (1). Images: ripe fruit, potter's vessels, arrow (1). Repetition and rhythm (1). Overall effect (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Villagers' responses (1). Buddha's care (1). Shared grief (1). Need for support (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Kisa Gotami got medicine from the Buddha; he asked her for **a handful of mustard seed** from a house where no one had died.
- Mistaking the sermon for a magical cure; it teaches that **death comes to all** and no house is free of it.
- Saying Kisa Gotami was cruel or foolish; she is a grieving mother who, after her search, is **enlightened** and becomes a disciple.
- Mixing up the place: the lesson is the Buddha's first sermon at **Benares**, preserved as a text on the nature of suffering.
- Not stating the final message: *life is full of suffering and death*, and peace comes from giving up grief and attachment.

- Spelling slips: *Kisa Gotami, sermon, mustard, Sakyamuni, enlightenment*; and quoting the Buddha without quotation marks.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 8: **The Sermon at Benares (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** turning one mother's loss into a universal truth	Specific to universal.
2	**(b)** such a task may not console everyone	Critical view.
3	**(a)** Accept the inevitable and help others who grieve	Core moral.
4	**(d)** inevitable fall of life	Fruits must fall.
5	**(d)** impermanence and compassion	Core ideas.
6	**(b)** Mother learns truth of life through a mustard seed	Fits.
7	**(a)** storytelling with dialogue	A story.
8	**(b)** carries a moral or spiritual purpose	Religious or moral.
9	**(a)** compassion without attachment	Buddhist ethics.
10	**(b)** parallelism	Repetition for effect.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It speaks of loss that all humans face (1) and uses everyday objects like mustard seed (1).	1+1
12	Individual sorrow is part of collective human experience (1) so sharing it eases it (1).	1+1
13	A harsh refusal could deepen denial (1) while gentleness lets her accept in her own time (1).	1+1
14	The story provides a concrete example (1) and the sermon turns it into general principle (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It creates rhythm (1). It emphasises universality (1). It makes the message memorable (1).	1+1+1
16	Simple, balanced sentences (1). Calm tone (1). Images that appeal to the common mind (1).	1+1+1
17	Life and death (1). Grief and peace (1). Denial and acceptance (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Vessels made by a potter all end by being broken (1). So every mortal life must end in death (1). It teaches that death is common to all and must be accepted (1).	1+1+1
18	No one can bring back the dead (1). Wealth and medicine fail (1). Acceptance is the only freedom (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It teaches acceptance of loss (1). It teaches compassion for others (1). It shows the value of reflection (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Loss is universal (1). Acceptance is healing (1). Modern distractions (1). Role of community (1). Balanced judgement (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Her grief (1). Her search (1). Her new peace (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Greeting (1). Her story (1). The lesson (1). Advice (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Telling vs showing (1). Task of the seed (1). Result (1). Other examples (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Kisa Gotami got medicine from the Buddha; he asked her for **a handful of mustard seed** from a house where no one had died.
- Mistaking the sermon for a magical cure; it teaches that **death comes to all** and no house is free of it.
- Saying Kisa Gotami was cruel or foolish; she is a grieving mother who, after her search, is **enlightened** and becomes a disciple.
- Mixing up the place: the lesson is the Buddha's first sermon at **Benares**, preserved as a text on the nature of suffering.
- Not stating the final message: *life is full of suffering and death*, and peace comes from giving up grief and attachment.
- Spelling slips: *Kisa Gotami, sermon, mustard, Sakyamuni, enlightenment*; and quoting the Buddha without quotation marks.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 8: **The Sermon at Benares (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** easing pain without removing the cause	The sermon eases pain.
2	**(a)** universalise the message	Accessible.
3	**(b)** impermanence	Anicca.
4	**(a)** understanding	Insight.
5	**(d)** education can be gentle and experiential	Learning by experience.
6	**(b)** remove the cause of suffering by understanding	Remove grief.
7	**(b)** Wealth can protect from death	Wealth cannot.
8	**(d)** persistence	She searches every house.
9	**(c)** death has touched almost every household	Universality.
10	**(d)** The seed had been asked for by the Buddha.	had been + participle.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It depends on the sufferer's openness to learning (1) and may not suit fresh, acute grief in all cases (1).	1+1
12	Their repetition builds a pattern (1) and drives home the universality of death (1).	1+1
13	He did not cancel her sorrow (1) but made her accept reality, which brings peace (1).	1+1
14	Any loss like failure or separation (1) can be eased by accepting its universality (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Acceptance recognises reality (1). Indifference ignores it (1). The Buddha teaches compassion with acceptance, not coldness (1).	1+1+1
16	As the proverb goes, what is born must die (1). Like a ripe fruit, life falls in time (1). Life is brief, but death is certain (1).	1+1+1
17	It is simple but deeply true (1). Grief needs time as well as understanding (1). The story offers a starting point (1).	1+1+1
	OR: A mother and a seed are simple (1). The idea of impermanence is deep (1). Simplicity makes it accessible (1).	1+1+1
18	The Buddha said to her, 'Death comes to all.' (1). Quotation marks are used (1). The reporting verb 'told' becomes 'said to' (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Listen with empathy (1). Ask guided questions (1). Let the person find the answer (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Lencho's faith (1). Kisa's acceptance (1). Both face loss (1). Role of helpers (1). Lessons (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Title and theme (1). Plot (1). Style (1). Strengths (1). Recommendation (1).	2+2+1
20	Setting (1). Character with loss (1). A wise guide (1). The task (1). Realisation (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Narrator (1). Dialogue (1). Sound cues (1). Climax (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

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MASTERMIND